Daily Bible Note

Date: 2026-11-03

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: Amos 1:1-8

1 The words of Amos, who was among the sheepbreeders of Tekoa, which he saw concerning Israel in the days of Uzziah king of Judah, and in the days of Jeroboam the son of Joash, king of Israel, two years before the earthquake.

2 And he said: "The LORD roars from Zion, and utters His voice from Jerusalem; the pastures of the shepherds mourn, and the top of Carmel withers."

3 Thus says the LORD: "For three transgressions of Damascus, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they have threshed Gilead with implements of iron.

4 But I will send a fire into the house of Hazael, which shall devour the palaces of Ben-Hadad.

5 I will also break the gate bar of Damascus, and cut off the inhabitant from the Valley of Aven, and the one who holds the scepter from Beth Eden. The people of Syria shall go captive to Kir," says the LORD.

6 Thus says the LORD: "For three transgressions of Gaza, and for four, I will not turn away its punishment, because they took captive the whole captivity to deliver them up to Edom.

7 But I will send a fire upon the wall of Gaza, which shall devour its palaces.

8 I will cut off the inhabitant from Ashdod, and the one who holds the scepter from Ashkelon; I will turn My hand against Ekron, and the remnant of the Philistines shall perish," says the Lord GOD.

II. Key Summary

- Amos, one of the sheepbreeders of Tekoa, received words concerning Israel in the days of Uzziah king of Judah and Jeroboam king of Israel, two years before the earthquake (v. 1).
- Amos says the LORD roars from Zion and utters His voice from Jerusalem; the pastures

of the shepherds mourn and the top of Carmel withers (v. 2).

• The LORD announces that for "three transgressions ⋯ and for four" He will not turn away the punishment of Damascus and Gaza: Damascus threshed Gilead with implements of iron, and Gaza took captive the whole captivity to deliver them up to Edom; He will send fire on their palaces and cut off their inhabitants and rulers (vv. 3–8).

III. Passage Analysis

Three Transgressions, and for Four

> "Three transgressions" — many and more; "three" is already quite a few, a whole number, and now there are even more; the evil has reached its full measure. This is said by way of numbers. "I will not turn away its punishment" shows that the LORD's judgment is certain, unchangeable, and cannot be avoided. [1]

Verses 3 and 6 open with the same line: Damascus and Gaza both have "three transgressions ⋯ and for four," and both times the LORD says, "I will not turn away its punishment."

Sin has piled on sin, and now the LORD will not take back what He has said.

Starting from the Neighbors

> God's judgments rolled round like a thunder-cloud, passing from land to land, giving warning of their approach, at last to gather and center on Israel itself, except it repent. In the visitations of others, it was to read its own⋯ [2]

Verse 1 says Amos saw these words "concerning Israel," yet verses 3–8 first name Damascus and Gaza (for the judgment on Israel, see 2:6-16).

God spoke first about the sins of other nations; when Israel heard it, Israel was also hearing a warning meant for itself.

Note: When did these things happen?

• Damascus threshed Gilead (v. 3): Elisha told Hazael king of Syria, "I know the evil that you will do to the children of Israel: Their strongholds you will set on fire, and their young men you will kill with the sword; and you will dash their children, and rip open their women

with child" (2 Kings 8:12). Later, in the days of Jehu, Hazael attacked "from the Jordan eastward: all the land of Gilead" (2 Kings 10:32-33), around 842–802 B.C. [3]

- Gaza delivered the whole captivity to Edom (v. 6): In the reign of Jehoram king of Judah, the Philistines and Arabians "came into Judah and invaded it, and carried away all the possessions that were found in the king's house, and also his sons and his wives" (2 Chronicles 21:16-17). Scripture records only the more notable of such raids. [4]
- Afterward:
  - Syria: In 732 B.C., the king of Assyria "went up against Damascus and took it, carried its people captive to Kir, and killed Rezin" (2 Kings 16:9), fulfilling verse 5. [1]
  - Philistia: In 734 B.C., Assyria attacked Philistia [1]; Hezekiah "subdued the Philistines, as far as Gaza" (2 Kings 18:8) [4]; Sargon king of Assyria sent his commander, who took Ashdod (Isaiah 20:1), and the Philistine land was later destroyed by Assyria. [1]
  - Israel: About 40 years later, Assyria did just what Amos said and attacked Israel, carrying the people away (2 Kings 17). [5]

IV. Reflection Question

When you see people around you make the same mistake three or four times, what do you take from it to remind yourself?

Damascus and Gaza were right around Israel; the LORD named their "three transgressions … and for four" and said, "I will not turn away its punishment"; this circle of judgment finally came to rest on Israel (2:6-16) and became Israel's warning [2].

References

[1] 華人基督徒查經資料網站 (Chinese Christian Bible Study), Amos 1 notes (Tang Yau-chi, Tien Dao Bible Commentary – Amos; Chain-Reference Bible Notes; Chinese Study Bible Notes), https://www.ccbiblestudy.org/Old%20Testament/30Amos/30GT01.htm

[2] BibleHub, Barnes' Notes on the Bible (Amos 1:3), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/1-3.htm

[3] BibleHub, Cambridge Bible for Schools and Colleges (S. R. Driver, Amos 1:3), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/1-3.htm

[4] BibleHub, Barnes' Notes on the Bible (Amos 1:6), https://biblehub.com/commentaries/amos/1-6.htm

[5] BibleProject, Book of Amos guide, https://bibleproject.com/guides/book-of-amos/